

SNOWPRO® CORE
COF-C03
EXAM STUDY GUIDE

Last Updated: July 8, 2026



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SNOWPRO® EXAM STUDY GUIDE OVERVIEW

Before you start studying for an exam, it is important to understand the exam content and format. This is a self-paced guide and will outline the Snowflake domains, objectives, and topics that will be covered on the exam.

Use this guide to develop a study plan, identify the areas you need to improve, and review the recommended resources. Prior to reviewing the exam study guide, please make sure you complete the following configurations:

- Snowflake University (using your Community log in)
- Snowflake 30-day free trial Account for Hands-On Labs

RECOMMENDATIONS FOR EXAM PREPARATION

Effective exam preparation requires more than reading and attending a training course. It involves using a variety of study and training assets to enhance your understanding of the exam content.



First, let's review some effective strategies for exam preparation:

1) **Set a timeline**: Schedule your exam and use that date as your target date. Plan ahead and create a study plan.
2) **Understand the exam format and content:** When reviewing the exam domain percentages, pay attention to the weightings in each domain and plan your study time accordingly. Some domains will have more questions than others.
3) **Study with Snowflake assets**: Use the exam outline as a checklist. Identify the objectives and topics you understand and the objectives you feel like you need more experience with.
4) **Take the Practice exam**: Gain familiarity with the question formats and insights on which topics you may need additional preparation in by taking our Practice exam found here.



Learning is different for everyone! If you learn better with an instructor leading the way, consider our Snowflake Instructor-Led Training recommendations:

Pathway 1

1. Snowflake Fundamentals Course
2. SnowPro Core On-Demand Preparation Course

Pathway 2

1. Snowflake Foundations On-Demand Training
2. Administering Snowflake Course
3. SnowPro Core On-Demand Preparation Course

SNOWPRO® CORE EXAM CONTENT AND FORMAT

CERTIFICATION OVERVIEW

The SnowPro Core Certification validates professionals with six months of practical, hands-on experience in the Snowflake AI Data Cloud. A SnowPro Core Certified individual has a thorough understanding of the Snowflake AI Data Cloud and has the knowledge necessary to develop and manage secure, scalable Snowflake solutions to drive business objectives.

This exam will validate that a candidate has the experience and skills to:

- Use the Snowflake AI Data Cloud architecture
- Manage Snowflake accounts and virtual warehouses
- Perform data loading, unloading, and transformation
- Use structured, semi-structured, and unstructured data
- Monitor and optimize performance
- Enable data collaboration and protection
- Establish Snowflake connectivity

Target Audience:

We recommend that individuals have at least 6 months of experience using the Snowflake platform prior to attempting this exam. Familiarity with basic ANSI SQL is recommended.

PREREQUISITE KNOWLEDGE

The exam does not cover cloud fundamentals or basics of SQL syntax, but some questions on the exam assume knowledge of these concepts. If you need assistance learning these concepts, we recommend you review some additional resources.

Database Basic Concepts

Basic Terminology Related to Databases and SQL
Tables and Data Types
Selecting and Manipulating Data
Views, Stored Procedures, Functions
Security (Authentication and Authorization)

Basics of Cloud Fundamentals

Types of Cloud Computing and Benefits
Types of Cloud Services
Cloud Computing Architecture (Storage and Compute)

EXAM DOMAIN AND WEIGHTINGS

The following table contains the domains and weightings covered on the exam. It is not a comprehensive listing of all the content that will be presented on the exam.

Domain	Domain Weightings
1.0 Snowflake AI Data Cloud Features and Architecture	31%
2.0 Account Management and Data Governance	20%
3.0 Data Loading, Unloading, and Connectivity	18%
4.0 Performance Optimization, Querying, and Transformation	21%
5.0 Data Collaboration	10%



Domain 1.0: Snowflake AI Data Cloud Features and Architecture

1.1 Describe and use the Snowflake architecture

- Cloud Services layer
- Compute layer
- Database Storage layer
- Compare and contrast the different Snowflake editions

1.2 Use Snowflake Interfaces and tools

- Snowsight
- Snowflake CLI
- IDE integrations (e.g., Visual Studio Code)

1.3 Differentiate Snowflake object hierarchy and types

- Organization and account objects
- Database objects
    - Stages
    - Schemas
    - Tables
    - Views
    - User-Defined Functions (UDFs)
    - File formats
    - Stored procedures
    - Pipes
    - Shares
    - Sequences
    - ML models
    - Applications
- Session and context variables
    - Parameter hierarchy
    - Parameter precedence

1.4 Configure virtual warehouses

- Types
    - Snowpark Optimized
    - Standard (Gen 1 and Gen 2)
    - Default warehouse for Notebooks* (Feature will not be tested until it's globally GA)
- Scaling policies
- Warehouse type and configurations based on use cases
    - Ad-hoc queries
    - Data loading
    - BI and reporting
- Best practices
    - Sizing (up, down)
    - Scaling (in, out)
    - Auto-Suspend
    - Workloads
        - Different teams
        - High concurrency
        - Complex queries

1.5 Explain Snowflake storage concepts

- Micro-partitions
- Data clustering
- Table types
    - Permanent
    - Temporary
    - Transient
    - Apache Iceberg™
    - External
    - Dynamic
- Views types
    - Standard
    - Materialized
    - Secure

1.6 Explain AI/ML and application development features

- Snowflake Notebooks
- Streamlit in Snowflake
- Snowpark
- Snowflake Cortex
    - AI SQL functions
    - Cortex Search
    - Cortex Analyst
- Snowflake ML

Domain 1.0 Study Resources

Snowflake University On Demand Trainings

Snowflake Foundations On-Demand Training
Badge 1: Data Warehousing Workshop
Snowflake University, Level Up: Snowflake's Key Concepts
Snowflake University, Level Up: Snowflake Ecosystem
Snowflake University, Level Up: Container Hierarchy
Snowflake University, Level Up: Accounts & Assurances
Snowflake x GenAI: LLM Functions
Snowflake x Gen AI: A Cool Collab

Getting Started With Snowflake

Module 1: Prepare your Lab Environment
Module 2: The Snowflake User Interface



Domain 2.0: Account Management and Data Governance

2.1 Explain Snowflake security model and principles

- Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)
- Securable object hierarchy
- Discretionary access control (DAC)
- Network Policies
- Authentication
    - Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)
    - Federated Authentication
    - Single Sign-on (SSO)
    - OAuth
    - Key-pair authentication
- System-defined roles
- Functional roles
    - Account roles
    - Database roles
    - Custom roles
- Secondary roles
- Account identifiers
- Logging and tracing

2.2 Define data governance features and how they are used

- Data masking
    - Row-level security
    - Column-level security
- Object tagging
- Privacy policies
- Trust Center
- Encryption key management
- Alerts
- Notifications
- Data replication and failover
- Data lineage

2.3 Explain monitoring and cost management

- Resource Monitors
    - Cost and warehouse monitoring
- Calculating virtual warehouse credit usage
- `ACCOUNT_USAGE` schema

Domain 2.0 Study Resources

Snowflake University On Demand Trainings

Snowflake University: Level Up: Resource Monitoring

FinOps for Snowflake

Getting Started With Snowflake

Module 9: Working with Roles, Account Admin & Account Usage

Reading Asset

Quickly Visualize Snowflake's Roles, Grants and Privileges (Article)

Definitive Guide to Managing Spend in Snowflake (White Paper)



Domain 3.0: Data Loading, Unloading, and Connectivity

3.1 Perform data loading and unloading

- File formats
- Create and use stages
  - Internal stages
  - External stages
  - Server-side encryption
  - Directory tables
- `COPY INTO` command
- Error handling options

3.2 Perform automated data ingestion

- Snowpipe
- Snowpipe streaming
- Streams
- Tasks
- Dynamic tables
- Openflow (Feature will not be tested until it's globally GA)

3.3 Identify the different Snowflake Connectors and integrations

- Snowflake drivers
- Snowflake connectors
- Storage integration
- API integration
- Git integration

Domain 3.0 Study Resources

Snowflake University On Demand Trainings

Snowflake University, Level Up: Data Loading

Getting Started With Snowflake

Module 4: Loading Structured Data into Snowflake: CSVs

Module 5: Loading Semi-Structured Data into Snowflake: JSONs

Reading Assets

Best Practices for Data Unloading (Article)

Best Practices for Managing Unstructured Data (E-book)

Structured vs Unstructured vs Semi-Structured Data (Blog)

Understanding Unstructured Data With Language Models (Blog)



Domain 4.0: Performance Optimization, Querying, and Transformation

4.1 Evaluate query performance

- Query Performance Tuning
  - Query Profile/Query insights
    - Bytes spilled to storage
    - Inefficient pruning
    - Exploding joins
    - Queuing
- `SNOWFLAKE.ACCOUNT_USAGE` views (Snowflake database views)
  - Query attribution
  - Query history
- Workload management best practices
  - Grouping similar workloads

4.2 Optimize query performance

- Query acceleration service
- Search optimization service
- Clustering keys
- Materialized views

4.3 Use Snowflake caching

- Query result cache
- Metadata cache
- Warehouse cache

4.4 Perform data transformation techniques

- Using data
  - Structured
  - Semi-structured
  - Unstructured
- Aggregate functions
- Applying SQL for query optimization
- Window functions

Domain 4.0 Study Resources

Snowflake University On Demand Trainings

Badge 3: Data Application Builders Workshop
Snowflake University, Level Up: Query History & Caching
Snowflake University, Level Up: Context

Getting Started With Snowflake

Module 7: Querying, the Results Cache, & Cloning

Videos

Accelerating BI Queries with Caching in Snowflake (Video)

Reading Assets

How to: Understand Result Caching (Article)
Performance Impact from Local and Remote Disk Spilling (Article)
Search Optimization: When & How to Use (Article)
How to Load Terabytes into Snowflake - Speeds, Feeds and Techniques (Blog)
Snowflake Materialized Views: A Fast, Zero-Maintenance Accurate Solution (Blog)



Domain 5.0: Data Collaboration

5.1 Explain data collaboration and protection

- Data replication and failover
- Secure data sharing features
- Cloning
- Time Travel
- Fail-safe

5.2 Explain Snowflake's data sharing capabilities

- Accounts
  - Provider
  - Consumer
  - Reader accounts
- Secure Data Sharing
- Sharing and resharing
- Direct shares
- Data clean rooms

5.3 Share data using the Snowflake Marketplace and listings

- Snowflake Marketplace
- Listings
  - Private
  - Public
- Native Apps

Domain 5.0 Study Resources

Snowflake University On Demand Training

Badge 2: Collaboration, Marketplace & Cost Estimation Workshop

Level Up: Native App Development for Beginners

Getting Started With Snowflake

Module 6: Getting Data from Snowflake Marketplace

Module 8: Using Time Travel

Module 10: Sharing Data Securely via Snowflake Marketplace

SNOWPRO® CORE CERTIFICATION SAMPLE QUESTIONS

1. A Snowflake Practitioner creates a stored procedure that queries a restricted sales table. The `SALES_ANALYST` role is granted `EXECUTE` on the procedure but does not hold `SELECT` on the underlying table. When analysts run the procedure, it succeeds because the default execution context uses the procedure owner's privileges. A new security requirement states that the procedure should fail for any caller who does not hold `SELECT` on the underlying table directly.

   Which change should the Practitioner make?

   A. Grant `SELECT` on the sales table to the `SALES_ANALYST` role so direct table access is aligned with procedure access.
   B. Re-create the stored procedure with `EXECUTE AS CALLER` so it runs using the calling role's privileges.*
   C. Grant `OWNERSHIP` on the procedure to the `SALES_ANALYST` role to transfer control over execution rights.
   D. Replace the table reference in the procedure with a secure view to restrict what each caller can retrieve.

2. A Snowflake Practitioner clones a schema that contains a table and a stream with several thousand unconsumed change records. After the clone is created, the Practitioner queries the stream in the cloned schema and finds it returns no records.

   What explains this behavior?

   A. Streams are not included when cloning a schema and must be recreated manually in the cloned schema.
   B. The cloned stream retains the same offset as the original stream, so records will appear after the original stream is next consumed.
   C. A cloned stream is initialized at the point of cloning and does not carry over pending change records from the original.*
   D. Cloning a schema copies the stream structure but not its internal state; records become visible only after the cloned table receives a new DML operation.

3. A multi-cluster warehouse handles dashboard queries for several hundred analysts. During peak hours, some queries wait a few seconds before executing. The team finds this acceptable. The team's priority is keeping the number of active clusters as low as possible to control costs.

   Which scaling policy should the Practitioner configure on this virtual warehouse?

   A. Standard because starts a new cluster as soon as any query is queued, regardless of current cluster load.
   B. Economy because waits until existing clusters are fully loaded before starting an additional cluster.*
   C. Standard because Economy mode adds latency to every queued query, which would cause dashboard timeouts for the analysts.
   D. Economy because prevents the warehouse from starting clusters beyond `MIN_CLUSTER_COUNT` during periods of low activity.

4. A Snowflake Practitioner runs a nightly pipeline that loads fresh data into a staging table. Before each load, all existing rows must be removed. The Practitioner currently uses `DELETE FROM staging_table`, but as the table has grown this step now takes several minutes. The table has `DATA_RETENTION_TIME_IN_DAYS = 0` and Time Travel is not needed.

   Which change reduces the time the cleanup step takes?

   A. Replace the `DELETE` with `TRUNCATE TABLE` to remove all rows in a single metadata operation.*
   B. Replace the `DELETE` with `DROP TABLE` followed by `CREATE TABLE` to reset the table to an empty state.
   C. Add a clustering key on the table's primary key column to help the `DELETE` locate and remove rows faster.
   D. Rewrite the `DELETE` as batched deletions using a `WHERE` clause on a date column to reduce transaction size.

5. A Snowflake Practitioner runs a nightly `COPY INTO` job loading CSV files from a named internal stage. A storage audit reveals the stage has accumulated six months of already-loaded files because the pipeline never removes them. The Practitioner needs to add a single option to the existing `COPY INTO` command that prevents loaded files from accumulating, without changing the pipeline's error handling behavior and without causing already-loaded files to be reloaded.

   Which option should the Practitioner add?

   A. `AUTO_INGEST = TRUE`
   B. `ON_ERROR = SKIP_FILE`
   C. `FORCE = TRUE`
   D. `PURGE = TRUE`*

NEXT STEPS

REGISTERING FOR YOUR EXAM

When you are ready to register for the exam navigate here to get started. Select the exam you want to take and click "Register Now". This will take you to our Certification Management system where you will register to take the exam.

MAINTAINING YOUR CERTIFICATION

All Snowflake Certifications expire two (2) years after your certification issue date.

SnowPro Certifications can now be recertified through the Snowflake Continuing Education (CE) program which includes these options -

- Completion of eligible Snowflake Instructor Led (ILT) Training Courses
- Earning of an equivalent or higher-level SnowPro Certification

Note: You must have a valid Certification to participate in the Continuing Education (CE) program.

The information provided in this guide is provided for your internal purposes only and may not be provided to third parties.

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